

## Delaware County Council Meeting January 28th 2025

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JhYxh6ixZbY">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JhYxh6ixZbY</a> |
| Publication Date | 2025-01-29T03:48:34Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Council Meeting Report

**Meeting Date:** January 28, 2025

**Body:** Delaware County Council

### 1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Council meeting to order at [00:04:44](#) on January 28, 2025.
- **Attendance:**
  - Members Present: Mr. Langan, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Smal [Smal/Smok], Mr. Bookout, Mr. Swad, Mr. Piper (President), and Dan [Viper/Flanagan as noted in roll calls].  
(Note: Individual attendance mapping in transcript roll calls includes Langan, Hughes, Smal, Bookout, Swad, Piper, and Dan).
  - Presiding Officer: Mr. Piper (President)

### 2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Brad Polk led the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:52](#).
- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was properly moved and approved by roll call vote ([00:01:48](#)).

- **Approval of Minutes:**
    - Minutes from the December 17 meeting were approved by roll call vote (00:02:08).
    - Special meeting minutes from January 2nd were approved by roll call vote (00:02:34).
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### 3. Substantive Business & Board Action

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#### Transfers & Appropriations

- **00:03:11 Fund Transfer - Ball Brothers Grant & Software:** Presented by Elizabeth and Tucker Diders (HBCU Director). Involves adjustments for Ball Brothers Grant training, renovation, and software/equipment.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote 00:04:19.
- **00:04:28 Appropriation / Position Change - Delaware County Highway:** Transfer from labor line (due to a retirement) to a truck driver position to accommodate a 26-year mechanic moving off concrete work on doctor's orders. The labor position will not be replaced.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote 00:05:32.
- **00:05:57 Appropriation - Deputy Registration Clerk:** Presented by Rich Bendler. Corrects a salary reduction from the end of the previous year.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** \$22 total appropriation approved by roll call vote 00:06:37.
- **00:06:56 Appropriation - Auditor (Part-Time & Grant Writer/Administrator):** Presented by Tanya Dunmore (Chief Deputy Auditor). Request for \$15,000 (part-time to cover maternity leaves) and \$80,000 (grant writer/administrator and software system).
  - **Motion to Amend:** Divided the question (Motion by Bill, seconded by Dan) 00:07:12.
  - **Part-Time Line (\$15,000):** Discussed staffing needs due to two pregnant employees.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote 00:12:48.
  - **Grant Writer / Administrator & Software (\$80,000):** Discussed splitting the line item to fund a contract (\$25k+2013>\$30k for grant management software) and a "Grant and Compliance Deputy" position (\$40k salary plus benefits, with half funded via ARPA funds approved by the Commissioners). Extensive public and department head input heard (Community Corrections, Coroner, HTCU).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table by Dan, seconded by Bill. **Tabled** by roll call vote 00:40:59.
- **00:41:37 Sheriff's Request - High-Tech Crime Unit (HTCU) & Longevity:** Presented by Nancy Marvin. Appropriation of \$46,528.18 (including longevity remainder, HTCU grant

salary return, and \$10,000 in seized drug task force funds for buy money). Followed by a major transfer of \$9,152.18 to contractual services [00:44:06](#).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Both appropriations approved by roll call vote ([00:43:36](#) and [00:44:33](#)).
- **[00:44:46](#) HTCU Additional Appropriations:** Appropriation of remaining state/rollover funds totaling \$35,235.38 across various operational lines (office supplies, operating supplies, transportation, repairs, training, equipment). Presented by Sheriff's office.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:47:55](#).
- **[00:48:10](#) Comprehensive Plan Fund:** Presented by Kylen Swackhammer (Planning Commission). Annual appropriation for non-reverting fund projects, consulting, and Ada updates (\$175,000 total).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:50:17](#).
- **[00:50:32](#) Unsafe Building Fund:** Presented by Kylen Swackhammer. \$75,000 for demolition and property cleanups funded via 10% of permit fees.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:51:57](#).
- **[00:52:13](#) GIS Map Fund:** Presented by Kylen Swackhammer. \$150,000 for GIS, aerials, storage, and software (80% reimbursable with agency contributions).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:53:33](#).
- **[00:53:46](#) Project Income Fund:** \$28,126 for a case manager position.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:54:11](#).
- **[00:54:21](#) Opioid Grant (Community Corrections):** Presented by Jane Miranda and Emily Anderson. \$59,017 total for peer recovery coach, client incentives, and kiosk lease.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:56:26](#).
- **[00:56:36](#) Sales Disclosure Fund:** Presented by James Carmichael (County Assessor). \$3,350 for training and software maintenance.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:57:22](#).
- **[00:57:36](#) Ineligible Homestead Standard Fund:** Presented by Tanya Dunmore. \$7,000 payable to a third-party vendor handling double homestead findings from past contract collections.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:59:52](#).
- **[00:06:00](#) Omnibus Financial Approvals:** Motion to approve financial transfers to amend the salary ordinance (with life reduction) and to receive the backfilling report.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote ([01:00:10](#) and [01:00:42](#)).

## Ordinances

- **[00:13:03](#) Ordinance 2025-02: PILOT Agreement for Foundry Row Apartments:** Presented by Ryan Kelly (TWG Development). First reading of an ordinance approving a PILOT agreement with TWG Construction LP for an affordable multi-family housing complex.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed HUD median gross income statistics and tax revenue distribution into TIF vs. general districts. County attorney is reviewing.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for first reading by roll call vote [01:03:37](#).

## Encumbrances

- [01:04:42](#) **2024 Encumbrances Approval:** Review of a large stack of encumbrance forms. Board members expressed disappointment regarding untimely submissions (some 6 months old) and lack of descriptions, calling for stricter future guidelines.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as presented by roll call vote [01:08:12](#).

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## 4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

*(Note: Public comments regarding the grant writer position were integrated into the substantive discussion under agenda item [00:06:56](#), featuring testimony from Jane Miranda [Community Corrections], Emily Anderson [Court Administrator], Gavin Green [Coroner], and Chuck Zile [HTCU]). No separate general open forum was conducted at the conclusion; floor comments were restricted to department updates.*

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## 5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Elected Officials & Department Head Updates:**
  - **Justin Curley (Purdue Extension):** Delivered annual impact report and invited council to the February 20th annual meeting at the Academy of Model Aeronautics [00:08:34](#).
  - **Gavin Green (Delaware County Coroner):** Reported 46 calls and 8 autopsies for January; introduced a financial variance tracking proposal for future months [00:09:30](#).
  - **Tony Skinner (Delaware County Sheriff):** Presented annual January update covering meal costs (\$1.75 average, 469,000 meals served), the Sheriff's pension report (76% funded), out-of-county/federal inmate billing revenues (\$1.5M total), training hours (11,500 hours), jail staffing improvements, a proposed part-time jail pay increase, and potential transition to a private food service vendor (Victus Food Service) [00:11:02](#).
  - **Future Financial Planning Committee:** Council discussed creating a strategic financial planning committee comprising the auditor, treasurer, three finance committee members, and a commissioner representative to proactively manage future debt and revenue losses (e.g., annexation and property tax cuts).
    - **Action:** Motion to draft a resolution creating the committee approved by roll call vote [01:31:38](#).

- **Board Oversight:** Discussion on requiring appointed boards to provide regular monthly updates to the council 01:34:58.
  - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by Dan, seconded by Jessica. Approved by roll call vote 01:36:21.
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